speak highly of the exposure MAIDS offers. "Meeting so many patients is great for confidence. You also get to build a really strong network of professionals—so that even now when I have patients, I can refer them further on to trusted professionals," says Dr Nida Nayyer, a 2015 BDS graduate, and currently a senior resident at AIIMS, Bhubaneswar.

What makes MAIDS unique is the fact that being the largest dental care provider in the country, it affords students the right infrastructure and equipment that might not be as easily available at any other dental college. Given the Make in India push, MAIDS is also leading the development of indigenous dental material and technologies. "As of today, about 95 per cent of dental technologies and materials are imported. Thanks to the prime minister's Make in India programme, there is a lot of interest in indigenous production and on being self-reliant. Our institute was recognised as a nodal centre for dental technology innovation this year," says principal Dr Sangeeta Talwar. MAIDS also recently started India's first dedicated dental technology innovation hub, under which eight technologies have already been incubated. "For example, in equipment, we incubated a project on ultrasound-based dental imaging. Another one was on finding ways to use bio-ceramics as filling material. One indigenous implant is already in the market," adds Dr Talwar.

Notably, a strong social outreach programme allows students to develop a sense of responsibility towards society.

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